

Accipiter striatus venator

Puerto Rican sharp-shinned hawk

Family (Accipitridae Vigors)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered)

Description

This bird is a small hawk measuring approximately 28 to 33 centimeters (11 to 13 inches). Adults are distinctive because of their dark slate gray upper parts and heavily barred rufous underparts, while immatures are brown above and heavily streaked below. It has short, squared tail, often appearing notched when folded, and small head and neck. In flight it has a characteristic short, rounded wings and long, narrow tail.



Location/Habitat

This species is found predominantly in montane forest with dense canopy cover, especially within high-elevation zones exceeding 900 meters. Its core habitat lies in protected areas with highly suitable ecological zones, making up approximately 0.6% of the island's area. Habitat loss due to deforestation and hurricanes has led to fragmentation of suitable montane forest environments. While some hawks have been spotted adjacent private forested areas, the most viable habitable patches are primarily located within protected montane reserves.



Sources: <https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/species/604>

https://ecos.fws.gov/docs/recovery_plan/970908.pdf

https://www.itis.gov/servlet/SingleRpt/SingleRpt?search_topic=TSN&search_value=824334#null